

DNA LEGAL

Advocates · Solicitors

Trusted Counsel. Decisive Results.

F I R M P R O F I L E

New Delhi · Supreme Court of India · Pan-India Network

Our Story

Our story did not begin today. It began decades ago at 3 Parliament Street, New Delhi, within the walls of one of India's pioneer law firms — J. B. Dadachanji & Company. This was a firm that did not merely practise law; it helped shape it, offering a uniquely holistic approach to clients navigating a newly-independent, dynamic India. Led by the legendary Mr. J. B. Dadachanji, Mr. Ravinder Narain, and Mr. O. C. Mathur, the firm became a benchmark for excellence in the Indian legal profession.

That legacy of benchmark-setting is our inheritance. After the demise of his partners, Mr. Ravinder Narain carried the torch forward, continuing the practice in his personal capacity under the name and style of "Ravinder Narain & Company." Today, the mantle has been passed to his senior associates, who founded DNA Legal to carry this profound legacy into a new era. DNA Legal is the modern manifestation of a timeless commitment to legal excellence.

At DNA Legal, our philosophy is straightforward: our client's interests are our own. We deliver clarity in complexity, transforming intricate legal challenges into strategic advantages. This client-focused approach marked by an unwavering responsiveness and the commercial sensibility of a trusted in-house team ensures we remain at the forefront of headline litigations across the country.

We are different by design. We pair our deep-rooted heritage with a future-focused, technology-driven practice. We believe in quality over quantity, ensuring every client receives the personal, partner-led attention their matter deserves. We see ourselves not merely as legal advisors, but as trusted partners in the Indian growth story dedicated to ensuring our clients thrive within it.

"The life of the law has not been logic; it has been experience." — Oliver Wendell Holmes Jr.

How We Practise

With a team of seasoned advocates and a Pan-India presence anchored in our principal office in New Delhi and our chambers at the Supreme Court of India, we are positioned to serve a diverse clientele from multinational corporations and public sector undertakings, to financial institutions, promoters and high-net-worth individuals.

Heritage, Carried Forward

We inherit a tradition of benchmark-setting advocacy from one of India's pioneer law firms. That inheritance is not nostalgia, it is a discipline of preparation, persuasion and accountability that shapes every brief we accept.

Partner-Led, Personal Attention

Every matter at DNA Legal is led by a partner or principal associate. There are no handovers to junior counsel after the pitch. Clients deal with the lawyer who knows their file from the first conference to the final hearing.

Commercial Sensibility

We are litigators, but we think like a board. Our advice is calibrated to commercial reality: cost of recovery, time value of money, reputational exposure and the cost of distraction to management. We tell clients when not to litigate, just as readily as we tell them when to.

Pan-India Reach

Through our principal office in New Delhi, our Supreme Court chambers and a vetted network of associate counsel across State High Courts, NCLT benches, DRTs and Commercial Courts, we serve clients in every commercial jurisdiction in the country.

Areas of Practice

DNA Legal offers a full spectrum of dispute resolution and advisory services, with a particular emphasis on commercial disputes and recovery. We appear before the Supreme Court of India, every major High Court, the NCLAT, NCLT, NCDRC, CCI, RERA, Debt Recovery Tribunals, Commercial Courts, and a wide range of statutory authorities including the Enforcement Directorate, the Serious Fraud Investigation Office, the Ministry of Corporate Affairs, and the Economic Offences Wing.

Commercial Disputes

Commercial disputes are the strategic core of our practice. We act for banks, non-banking financial companies, manufacturers, traders, infrastructure majors, real estate developers, technology companies and promoters in disputes where the amount in controversy is material, the timeline is sensitive, and the reputational stakes are real.

We approach every commercial dispute as a recovery exercise first and a legal exercise second. Drafting, forum selection, interim relief, asset tracing, settlement architecture and execution strategy are sequenced from day one. The objective is not a paper victory — it is money in the client's account, or the client's position protected from exposure.

Recovery Suits

We routinely prosecute and defend recovery actions before the Commercial Courts under the Commercial Courts Act, 2015 and the Debt Recovery Tribunals under the Recovery of Debts and Bankruptcy Act, 1993. Our practice covers the full toolkit: summary suits under Order XXXVII CPC, applications under Section 19 of the RDB Act, SARFAESI proceedings, attachment before judgment, Garnishee and Mareva-style interlocutory relief, and execution against the judgment debtor's movable, immovable and financial assets. We act both for institutional lenders pursuing recovery and for corporate borrowers defending claims, with the perspective of one side sharpening our work on the other.

Contract Enforcement

We have built a distinguished practice in suits for specific performance, damages for breach of contract, mortgage suits and the rendition of accounts i.e. the bread and butter of commercial dispute work, and the area in which careful pleading and discovery most often decides the case. We are particularly experienced in disputes arising out of supply, distribution and dealership agreements, shareholder and joint venture agreements, construction and EPC contracts, and inter-corporate financial arrangements.

Commercial Arbitration

We act as counsel in domestic and institutional arbitrations seated in India. Our work spans construction and infrastructure claims, FMCG sector, and contractual damages. We also handle the full range of court support work that flanks an arbitration ensuring that the award the client wins is the award the client recovers.

Constitutional & Taxation

The firm's constitutional and taxation practice combines a sustained appellate record with the day-to-day craft of statutory interpretation, assessment-stage litigation and advisory work. Our work spans the full life of an indirect tax matter from response to summons, statement recording and search proceedings, through adjudication, the Appellate Authorities, the Appellate Tribunals, and on to the High Courts and the Supreme Court of India. The firm acts in disputes under the Goods and Services Tax regime, the Customs Act, the legacy Central Excise and Service Tax statutes, and the surviving body of State levies including Value Added Tax, Entry Tax, Electricity Duty, Motor Vehicle Taxation, Luxury Tax, Entertainment Tax and the cesses associated with each. Within the GST regime, we regularly handle classification and valuation challenges, denial of input tax credit, refund litigation, transitional credit claims, anti-evasion and search-and-seizure proceedings, and writ challenges to arrest and provisional attachment under Section 83 of the CGST Act. The firm regularly appears in writ proceedings under Articles 32, 226 and 227 of the Constitution. Our constitutional work covers challenges to executive action, public-law disputes arising out of regulatory levies and licensing decisions, the constitutional dimensions of corporate transactions, and Article 14 challenges to discriminatory administrative measures. We also advise boards and promoter groups on the constitutional risk associated with policy and regulatory exposure.

Real Estate

Our unique positioning in the real estate sector — with simultaneous experience on the developer side and the home-buyer side — gives us a 360-degree perspective on every dispute. We appear before the Supreme Court, High Courts, the NCDRC and State Consumer Commissions, RERA authorities and appellate tribunals, the NCLT and NCLAT, and criminal courts where allied proceedings arise. The firm has acted in some of the largest real estate disputes in the country, including the DLF matter before the Competition Commission of India (penalty of ₹ 630 crores), the Raheja Developers refund matter before the NCDRC (above ₹ 80 crores), and the Kolkata West International matter before the NCDRC (claim above ₹ 90 crores). We have represented home-buyer associations of over 850 and 1,600 members in landmark proceedings, including the matter that established home buyers as financial creditors under the IBC.

Insolvency & Bankruptcy

We advise and represent resolution professionals, liquidators, committees of creditors, financial creditors, operational creditors, home-buyer authorised representatives and personal guarantors before the NCLT and NCLAT under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016. Through Mr. Sushil Kumar Singhal, a registered Insolvency Professional with the IBBI, the firm offers fully integrated insolvency services from pre-CIRP positioning to resolution plan negotiation, avoidance applications, and liquidation. Our IBC team is supported by the firm's commercial litigation bench, which positions us well for the contested and high-value end of the practice.

Banking & Finance

On the financing side, our work is predominantly borrower-side. We advise corporate borrowers, promoters and personal guarantors on debt restructuring, one-time settlements, SARFAESI defence, DRT and DRAT proceedings, restructuring under the RBI's Prudential Framework, and the strategic interface

between security enforcement and IBC. We act for promoters in promoter-classification disputes, fraud classification challenges under the Master Directions on Frauds, and writ challenges before the High Courts arising out of recovery actions.

Private Client Practice

Our private client practice serves promoter families, industrialists and high-net-worth individuals on matters that sit at the intersection of family, succession and commerce. Our work includes family settlements and partition arrangements; will drafting, probate and letters of administration; private trust structures and succession planning; matrimonial and custody disputes for HNI clients; and private property and real estate disputes distinct from our institutional real estate practice. We bring the same litigation muscle to these matters that we bring to our commercial work — with the added discretion and sensitivity these matters demand.

White Collar & Economic Offences

We represent corporates, directors, promoters and professionals in proceedings before the Enforcement Directorate, the Serious Fraud Investigation Office, the Economic Offences Wing, the Ministry of Corporate Affairs and the CBI. Our work spans PMLA proceedings, summons and interrogation strategy, search and seizure, bail and anticipatory bail, look-out circulars, attachment of properties, and adjudication and appellate proceedings before the Appellate Tribunal under PMLA.

Allied Criminal Litigation

Commercial disputes frequently spawn allied criminal proceedings and complaints before the Economic Offences Wing. We handle these proceedings as an integrated part of the commercial brief, ensuring that the criminal docket is used or defended in service of the client's overall commercial objective.

The Team

DNA Legal is structured to combine the experience of senior partners with the agility of a new generation of professionals. Every brief is partner-led, and every client is paired with a senior point of contact for the duration of the engagement.

Partners

Ajay Aggarwal — Founding Partner

Life Member, Supreme Court Bar Association · SCBA Membership A-00348

Mr. Ajay Aggarwal is the Founder of the firm. In his two decades of practice he has focused primarily on litigation and advisory work in constitutional law and taxation, with a special reference to indirect taxes both Central and State including Central Excise, Customs, Service Tax, Sales Tax, Entry Tax, Motor Vehicle Taxation, Electricity Duty, VAT, GST and other State levies and cesses. He has also handled significant matters in direct taxation, SEBI laws, company law, securitisation, property law, contracts and arbitration.

Mr. Aggarwal has briefed and instructed leading designated Senior Advocates of the Supreme Court and the High Courts many of whom were subsequently elevated to the Bench. He has independently appeared in numerous matters before the Supreme Court of India and a majority of the High Courts in the country, and has argued matters before various Tribunals, regulators and statutory authorities. His work is reflected in more than 150 reported judgments.

Adarsh Kumar Aggarwal — Founding Partner

Mr. Adarsh Aggarwal is a distinguished legal professional who co-founded the firm. With over two decades of experience, his practice is centred on the Delhi High Court, the Punjab & Haryana High Court and quasi-judicial tribunals. He heads the commercial disputes practice of the firm and his areas of expertise span civil and commercial litigation, with a strong emphasis on recovery suits, rendition-of-accounts cases, mortgage suits, winding-up matters, and arbitration. He also handles allied criminal matters that frequently emerge alongside civil and commercial litigation. This integrated approach allows him to provide clients with comprehensive, end-to-end representation.

Sushil Kumar Singhal — Partner

IBBI Registered Insolvency Professional

Mr. Sushil Kumar Singhal brings more than twenty-five years of experience in highway and building construction including project planning, preparation, supervision and contract management on more than twenty projects with an aggregate cost of approximately ₹ 6,000 crores to a five-year insolvency practice. As a Registered Insolvency Professional with the IBBI, he provides the full spectrum of insolvency services to clients, including liquidations, voluntary arrangements, administration, receiverships and bankruptcy. He is actively engaged in insolvency, restructuring and reorganisation proceedings under the Companies Act, 1956 / 2013 and the IBC, 2016, and regularly appears before the NCLT and the Delhi High Court. He is a member of the NCLT/NCLAT Bar Association, the DHCBA and the SCBA.

Parveen Bhati — Partner

Mr. Parveen Bhati heads the firm's criminal litigation practice. He brings nearly three decades of courtroom experience across trial and appellate work in criminal litigation. His practice covers the full criminal calendar, including offences under the IPC, the Negotiable Instruments Act, the Prevention of Money Laundering Act, the Prevention of Corruption Act and prosecutions under the Companies Act.

Mr. Bhati has served as Additional Public Prosecutor for the State of Delhi. That prosecutorial experience informs the strategy he brings to the firm's defence mandates today. He has also served as a Member of the OBC Commission for Delhi.

Principal Associates***Siddharth Banthia — Principal Associate***

Mr. Siddharth Banthia anchors the firm's real estate and insolvency dispute practice. He has over a decade of contested practice before the National Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission, the State and District Consumer Commissions, the National Company Law Tribunal and Appellate Tribunal, the Competition Commission of India, RERA authorities and appellate tribunals, the Punjab & Haryana High Court, the Delhi High Court and the Supreme Court of India. His work covers the full life cycle of a real-estate or commercial project dispute. He advises and represents financial and operational creditors and resolution professionals with particular focus on real-estate CIRPs, contested admission proceedings, and avoidance applications. His combined exposure to the consumer, RERA and IBC forums gives him an uncommon ability to sequence remedies across statutes.

Vishnu Kant — Principal Associate

Mr. Vishnu Kant is an Advocate-on-Record at the Supreme Court of India and conducts the firm's filings and proceedings before the Court. His practice spans the full range of original and appellate work before the Court, including Article 32 writ petitions, Article 136 special leave petitions, transfer petitions, and review and curative petitions, across the firm's commercial, real estate, insolvency, taxation and criminal mandates. He works closely with the firm's partners and arguing counsel on the strategic positioning of matters and is responsible for the conduct of the firm's Supreme Court docket.

Abhishek Dagar — Principal Associate

Mr. Abhishek Dagar anchors the firm's commercial disputes, real estate and taxation practice. His commercial work covers recovery proceedings and summary suits before the Commercial Courts, proceedings under the Negotiable Instruments Act, and contractual disputes arising out of inter-corporate dealings. On the real estate side, he represents clients in proceedings before the National Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission, the State Consumer Commissions, the RERA authorities and their appellate tribunals, and the civil courts in disputes concerning refunds, delayed possession, project deficiencies, and allied claims arising out of developer insolvency. He also appears on writ matters against Development Authorities and other statutory bodies before the High Courts across the country, and on appellate matters before the Supreme Court of India. His work also covers indirect tax litigation under the Goods and Services Tax regime, the Customs Act, and the legacy Central Excise and Service Tax statutes including classification and valuation disputes, refund litigation and denial of input tax credit.

Mukul Singhla — Principal Associate

Mr. Mukul Singhla is a key member of the firm. His practice focuses on commercial suits before the Commercial Courts and the Punjab and Haryana High Court, recovery proceedings before the Debt Recovery Tribunal, contractual disputes, arbitration and shareholder litigation. He works closely with the firm's lending and corporate clients on the strategic structuring of recovery actions, security enforcement and settlement architecture. He is recognised within the firm for the quality of his drafting and is often the principal author of the firm's pleadings in high-value commercial matters.

Sandeep Sharma — Project, Construction & Contract Management

Mr. Sharma brings extensive cross-disciplinary experience in the planning, monitoring and execution of construction and infrastructure projects across India and abroad. He works with the firm's lawyers on the techno-commercial aspects of construction and EPC disputes, including the preparation of project schedules, cost estimates, claims documentation and contract analysis.

Associates

The firm's associates support partner-led mandates across litigation and advisory work, with a focus on drafting, research, hearings before Tribunals and District Courts, and client communications.

- Rajnandini Dutta — Associate
- Sarthak Singh — Associate
- Shikha Bharti — Associate

Client Community

The firm and its lawyers have acted for, or on instructions from, a representative cross-section of Indian and multinational businesses, public sector undertakings, banks and financial institutions, and individuals.

A non-exhaustive list of past and present clients includes:

Public Sector & Government

Steel Authority of India Limited · Tata Iron and Steel Co. · Life Insurance Corporation of India · Haryana Tourism Corporation · Rashtriya Ispat Nigam

Banking & Finance

Jammu and Kashmir Bank · Indian Overseas Bank · LIC Housing Finance

Real Estate & Infrastructure

DLF Limited · Raheja Developers Limited · Dhoot Infrastructure Limited · Parsvnath Developers · M3M Group · Kolkata West International City

FMCG, Manufacturing & Industry

Nestle · Tata Motors · United Phosphorus · ITC · Coca-Cola India · Hindustan Coca-Cola Beverages Pvt. Ltd. · Hindustan Unilever Limited · Parle Agro Limited · Colgate · MRF · Ashok Leyland · KEC International · Orient Fans · Sanden Vikas · Sukhjit Starch and Chemicals

Other Corporates

Gem International · SPL Limited · High Polymers · Frick India · General Engineering Works · Melco India · Delkon Textiles · Coir Foam India · Modern Transformers · ABC Transformers · Bharat Insulation Co. · Hindusthan Vidyut Products · Ubique Electricals · Doaba Milk Plant · Alpine Apparels

Presence

Principal Office — New Delhi

4A, Mathura Road, Jangpura-A, New Delhi - 110014

Supreme Court of India

Chamber No. 101, A. K. Sen Block, Supreme Court of India, New Delhi

Pan-India Network

Through a vetted network of associate counsel and arguing advocates, DNA Legal serves clients before every major High Court, NCLT bench, Debt Recovery Tribunal, Commercial Court and RERA authority across India. This network is supervised by the firm's partners from New Delhi, ensuring uniform standards of drafting, strategy and client reporting wherever the matter is filed.

Bar & Professional Memberships

The firm and its lawyers hold memberships with, and regularly appear before, the following bar associations and professional bodies:

- Supreme Court Bar Association (SCBA)
- Bar Council of Delhi
- Bar Council of Punjab and Haryana
- Delhi High Court Bar Association (DHCBA)
- NCLT and NCLAT Bar Association
- Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India (IBBI) — Registered Insolvency Professional
- Delhi Bar Association
- New Delhi Bar Association

Why DNA Legal

Heritage that translates into instinct.

Decades of institutional memory carried forward from one of India's pioneer law firms inform the way we read a brief, anticipate the other side and structure a strategy.

Pan-India reach, single point of accountability.

Wherever the dispute is, the firm appears — with a single partner answerable for the brief from filing to satisfaction.

Commercial sensibility, by design.

We tell clients when not to litigate, just as readily as we tell them when to. The result is a working relationship that pays for itself.

Contact

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